Benedict Graf

Product Experience & Digital Processes

Berlin

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Hay, I’m Ben.



I shape digital experiences and the processes behind them – for customers and for the teams who run the business every day.

I make the way organisations work simpler, with solutions that are digital where it helps and non-digital where that works better. Depending on the situation, that is a new product, an adapted or automated process, or a smarter connection of existing tools.

For nine years I have worked on products, platforms and processes at Lufthansa Group, Deutsche Telekom, Berliner Stadtreinigung and Kieback & Peter. I analyse how things work today, align business and operational teams on a shared target picture, and take it through prioritisation and roadmap to solutions that can be rolled out at scale.

I work research-led and hypothesis-driven, so that changes and their impact can be measured against KPIs.

I have built, led and mentored teams of 5–10 people, and I teach Agile & Creative Methods at the University of Europe for Applied Sciences. Since 2026, I have been focusing on using AI tools to build services, products and automated workflows for small and medium-sized businesses.

Contents

This document showcases projects in which I played a significant role and gives an overview of my skills and way of working.

01 **BSR**
Platform strategy, service operations, digital experience

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Conversational sales, KPIs & business cases, conversion

03 **Nimuna**
Market & user research, product concept, go-to-market plan

04 **Sneak Peaks** (with live demo)
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05 **Kieback & Peter**
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06 **Methods**
Overview of applied methods and tools

Project references



- Development of a platform strategy to transform a waste management company into a zero-waste enabler
- Definition of revenue streams and derivation of business potential
- Development of a central, mobile-first product to activate the strategy

Goal

Realign a municipal utility as a modern, digital sustainability enabler

Roles

Lead strategic consultant, change management, coach for the internal innovation team

Methods

User archetypes, front-to-back-stage service mapping, co-creation workshops, revenue modelling

Impact

Platform strategy with new revenue streams; internal teams enabled to build services themselves

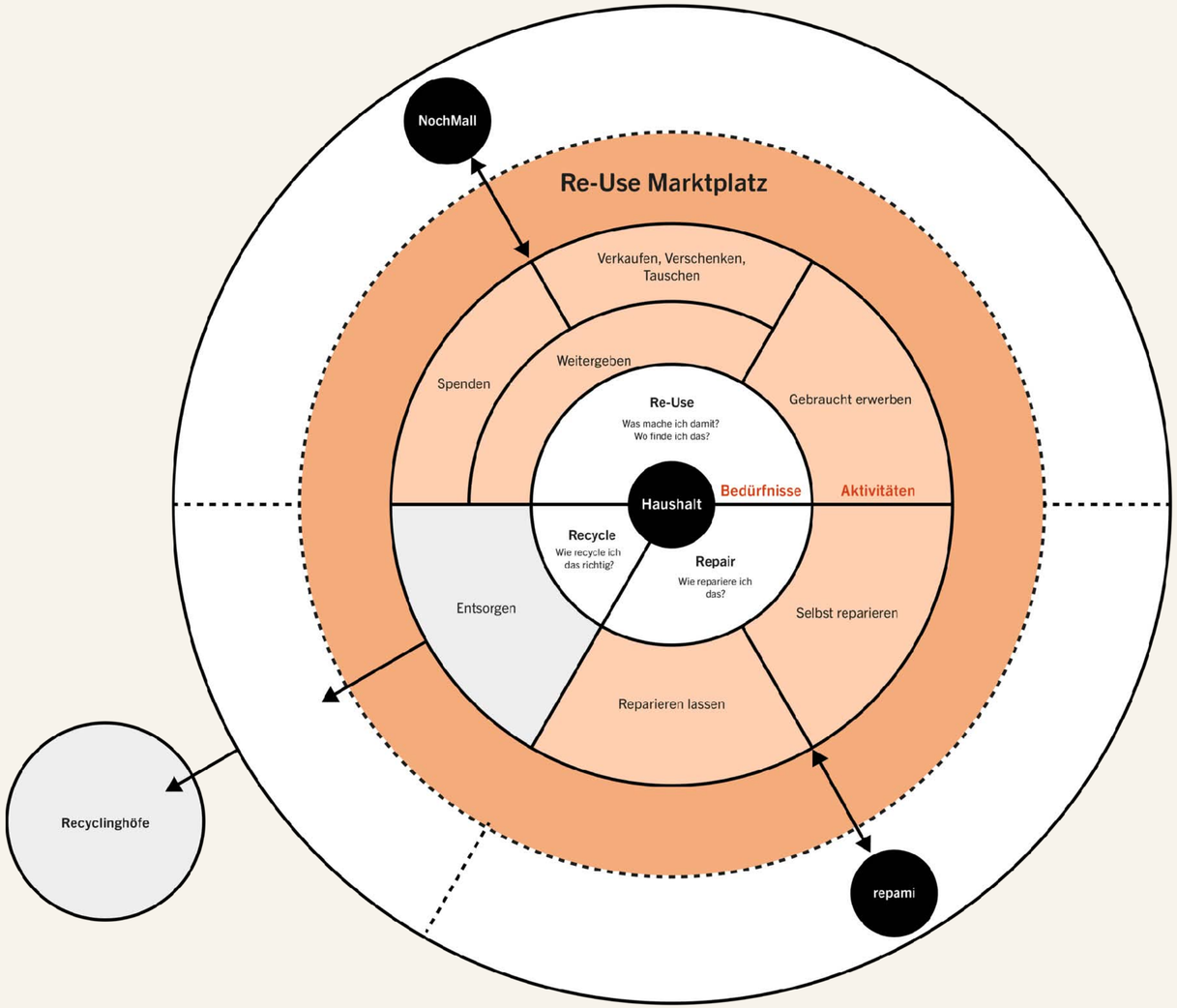
One central platform unlocks service potential

Berliner Stadtreinigung (BSR) is the largest municipal waste management company in Germany and one of the largest in Europe.

Alongside its core fields of city cleanliness and resource conservation, BSR is the key partner in delivering the zero-waste and waste-prevention strategies defined by the Berlin Senate.

Strategically developing a central platform with a multi-service architecture lets the company continuously contribute to its political, economic and business goals – with a broad service portfolio and additional revenue streams.

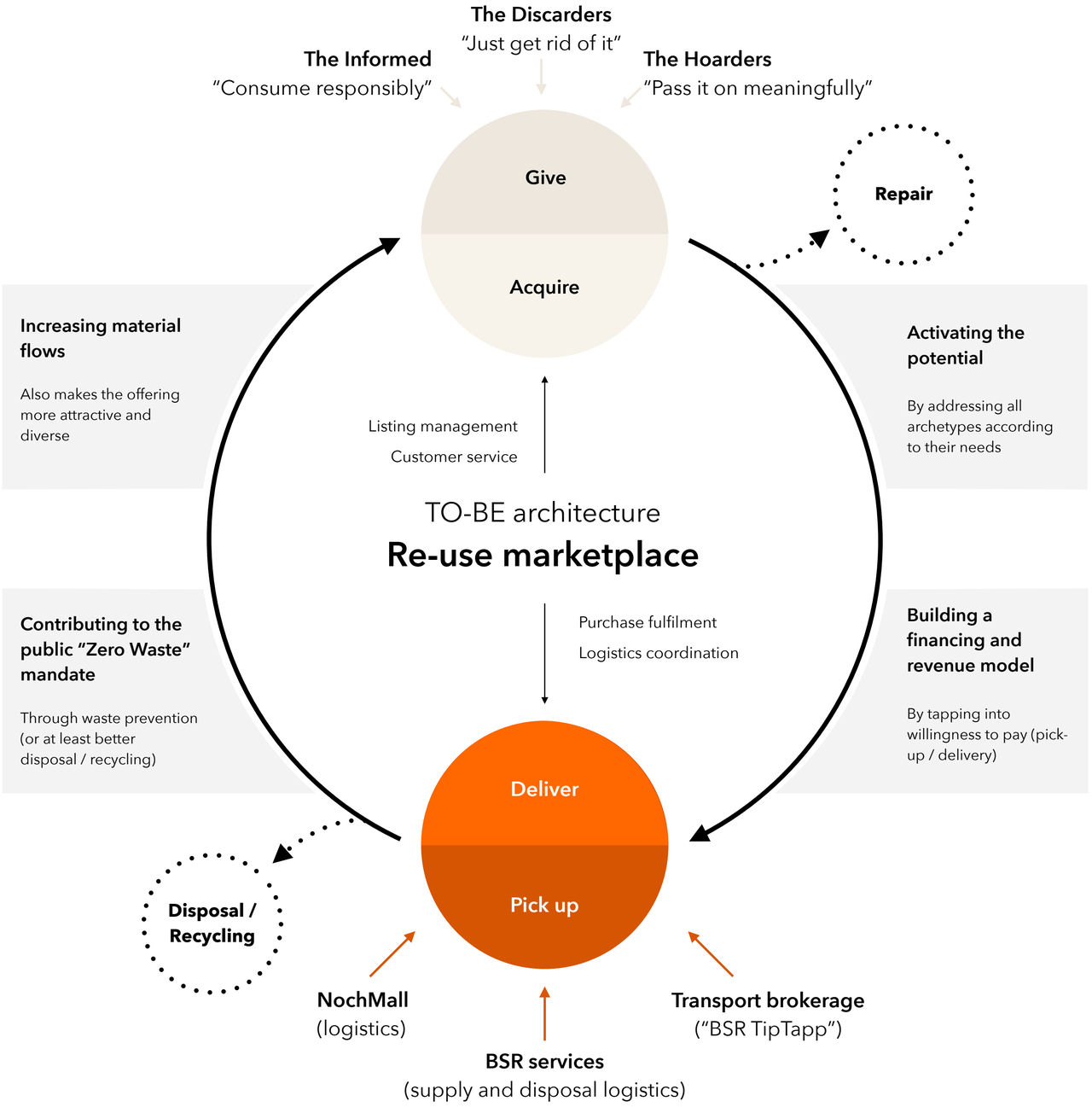
The platform shows how existing services interact and identifies gaps and potential for future services and their integration along the fields of re-use, repair and recycle.



Revenue streams by target group and platform service

Combining service requirements, goals and needs reveals new and adapted revenue streams that follow the needs of the target groups and the services within the platform.

Linking services and activating potential creates the bigger picture for building sales channels – always guided by the social contribution for fee payers, the city and the state.

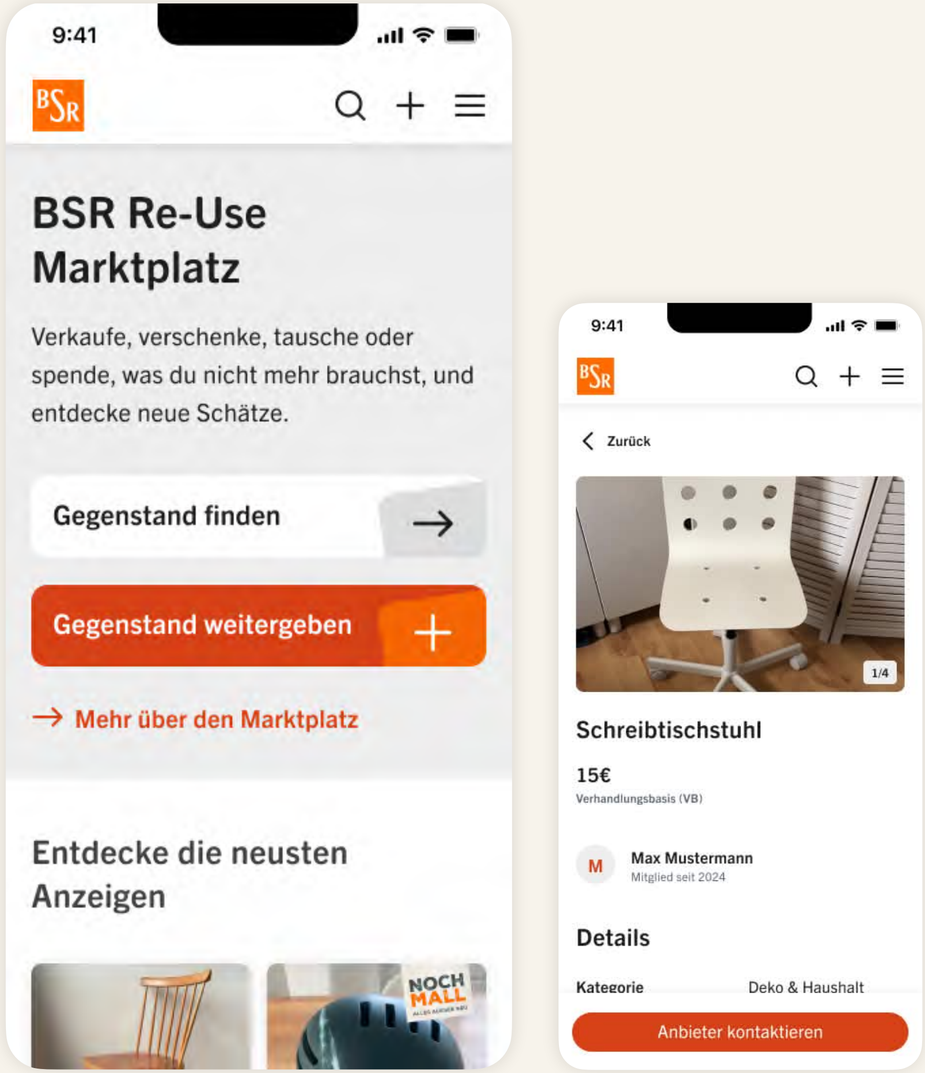


POC: A mobile-first platform to activate the platform strategy

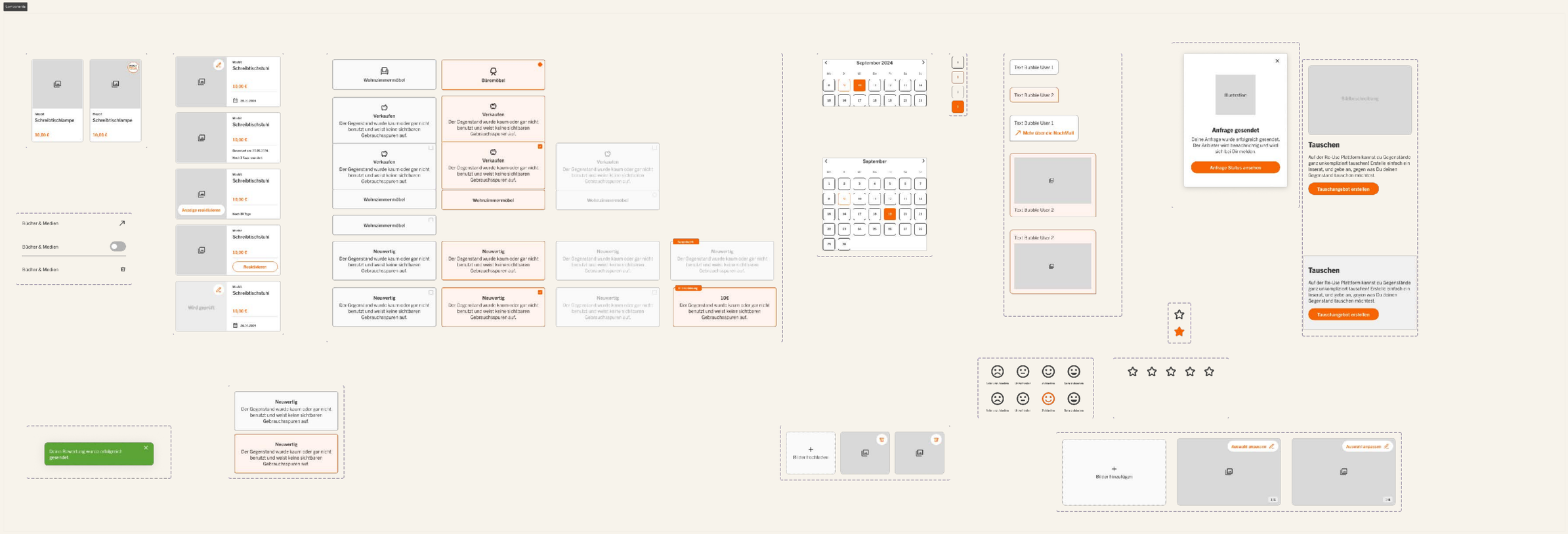
A first digital, mobile-first product turns the platform strategy into reality.

The product is the central entry point to the future ecosystem. It aims to build an active community in which all participants contribute to the political, social and economic goals through needs-based services.

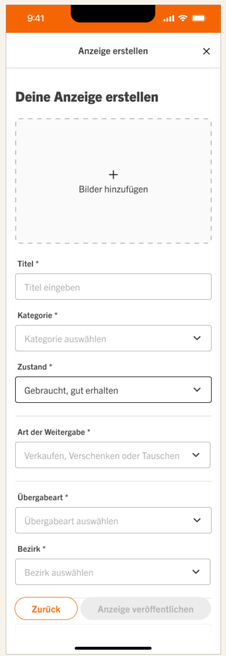
By continuously connecting further services, products and partner networks, the product gains relevance and visibility.

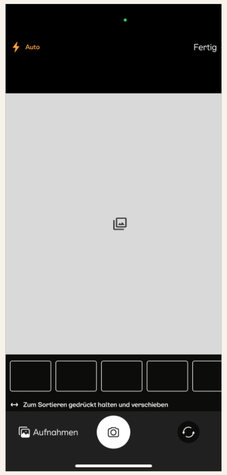


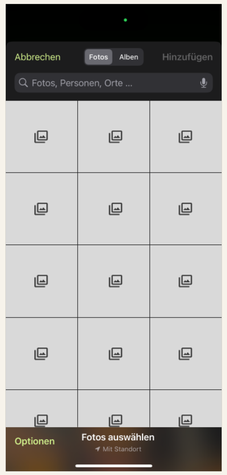
Building blocks for scaling the platform (component library)

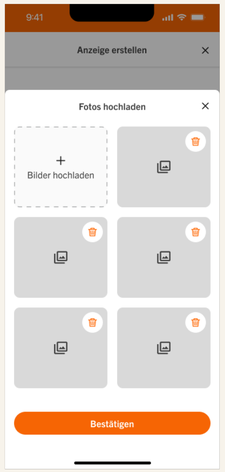


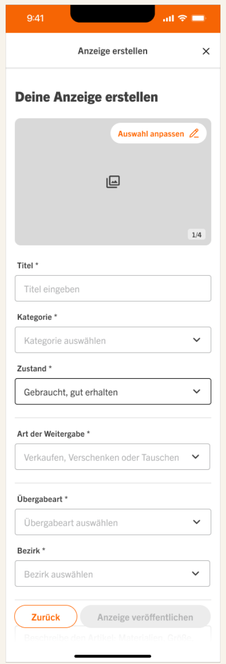
Core journey: creating a listing and selling an item

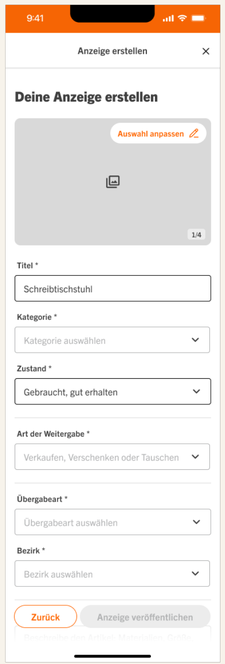


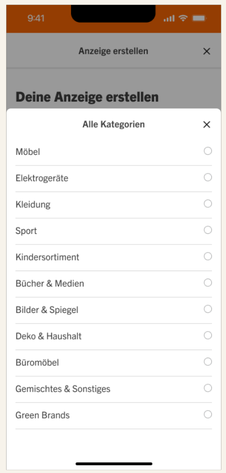


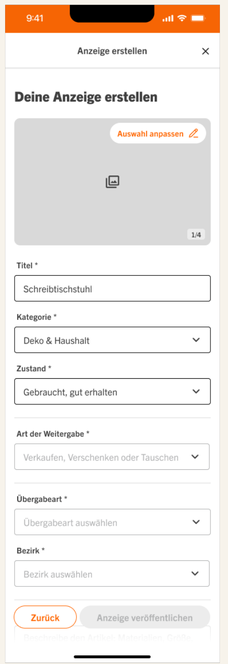


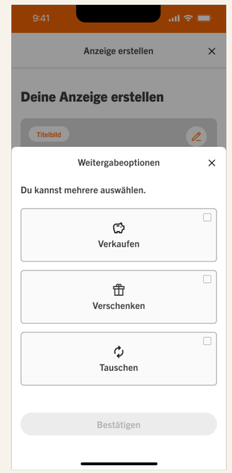




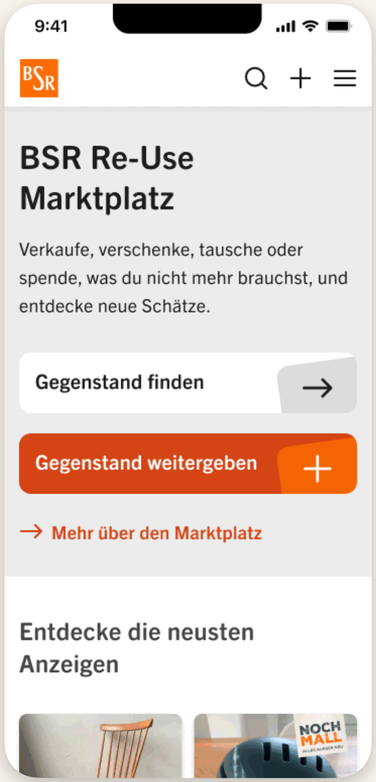


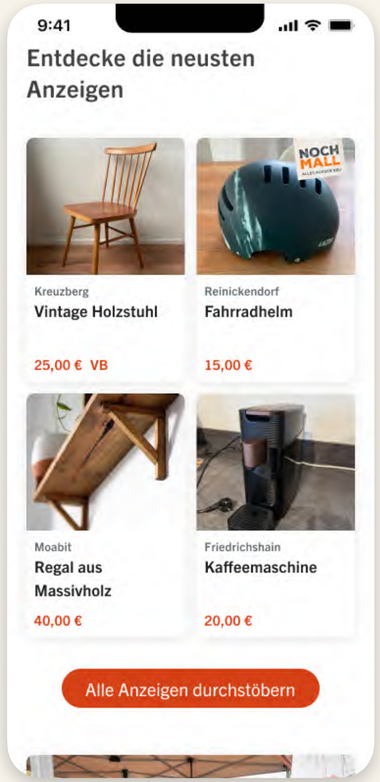




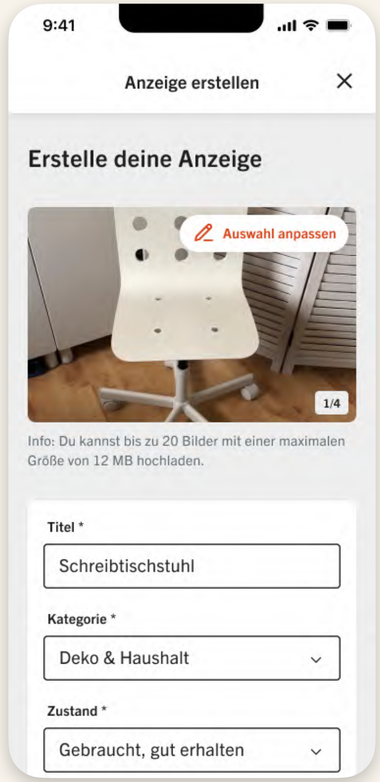


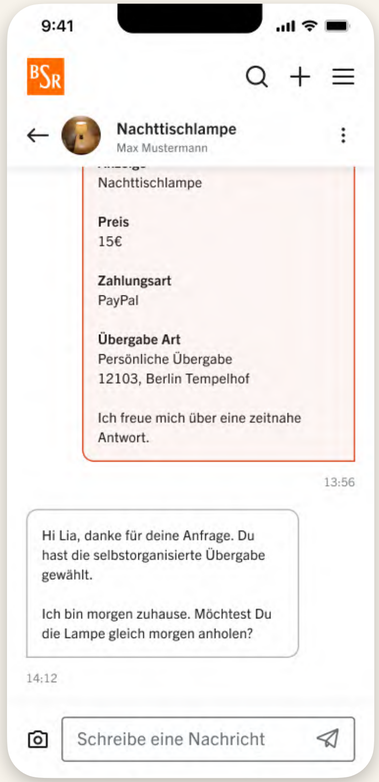
Platform live in action











- Development and scaling of a conversational AI sales channel
- Expert advice and leadership of the innovation project across several investment phases
- Coordination of cross-functional teams, stakeholders and service providers
- Development and evaluation of business KPIs and tracking mechanisms

Goal

Research, design and scale a conversational sales channel (app and messaging)

Roles

Strategy and experience lead

Methods

KPI and tracking concept, business cases for the stage-gate process, coordination of cross-functional teams

Impact

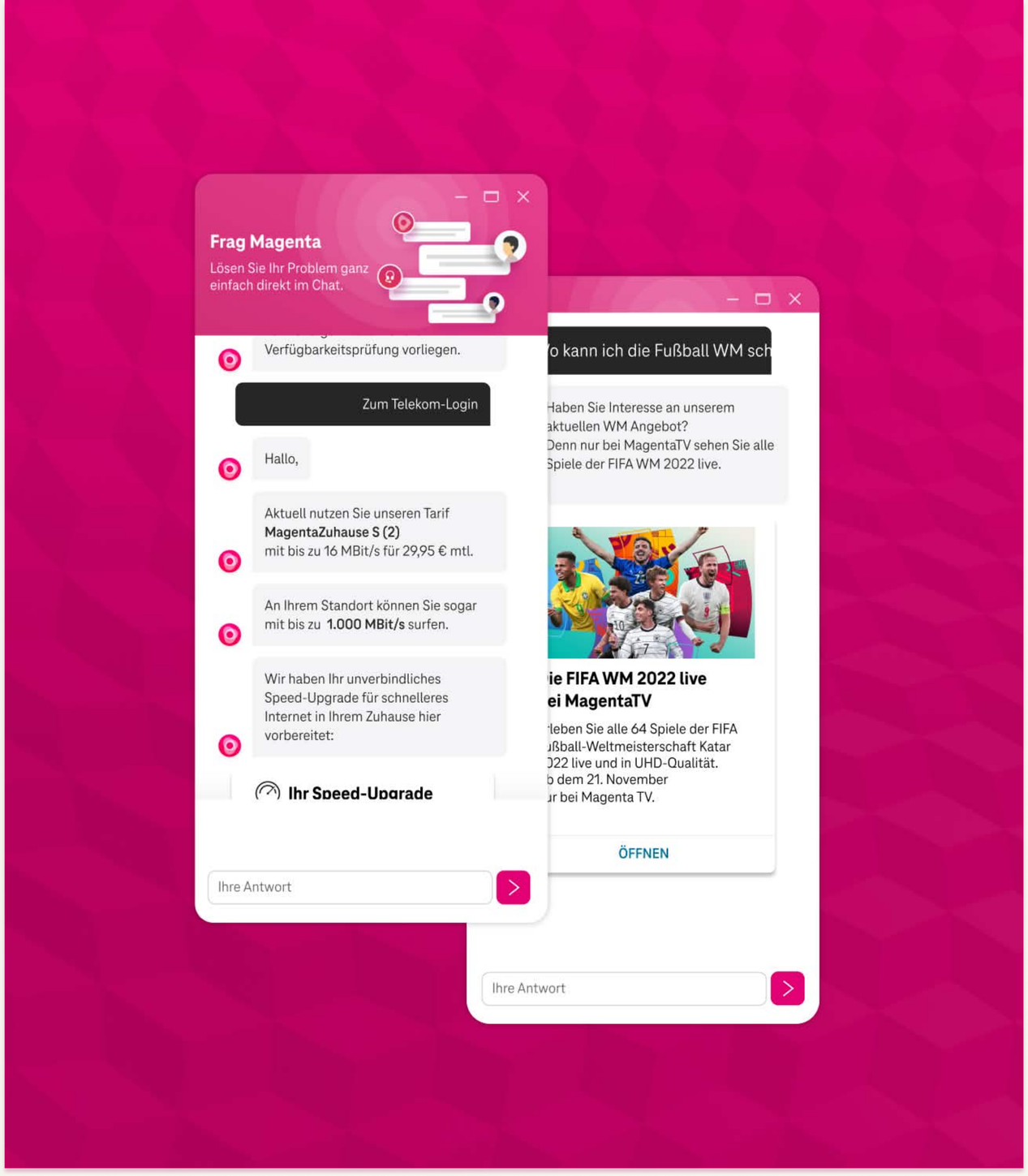
4% conversion rate; scaled across several service channels over 3 years and 4 investment phases

Revenue growth through automated sales processes

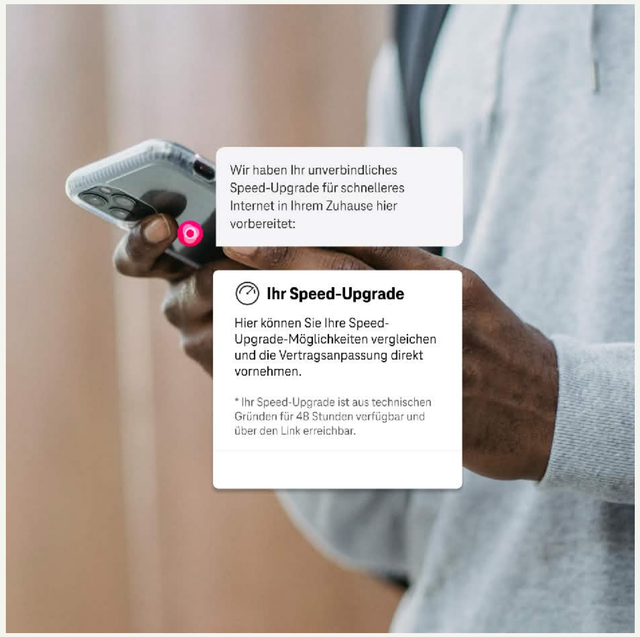
Besides traditional customer touchpoints, Deutsche Telekom offers automated messaging channels for service requests on the web, in the MeinMagenta app and on WhatsApp.

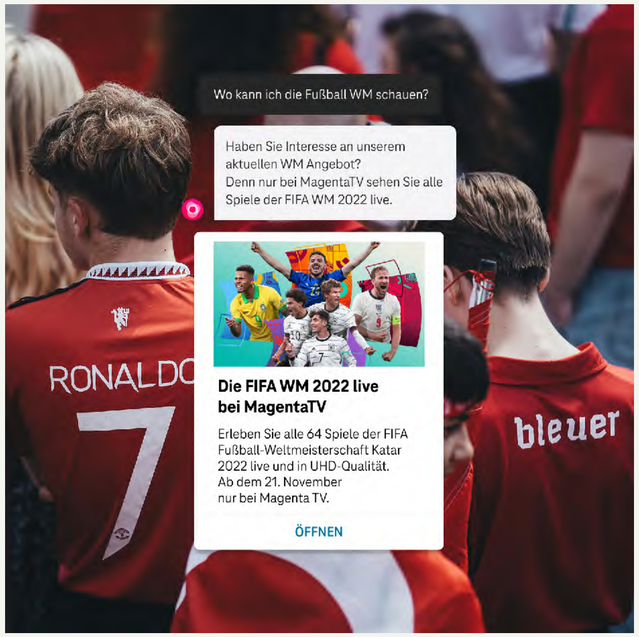
As part of an internal innovation initiative, a fully automated sales layer was built on the existing service infrastructure to enable a seamless, conversational sales strategy.

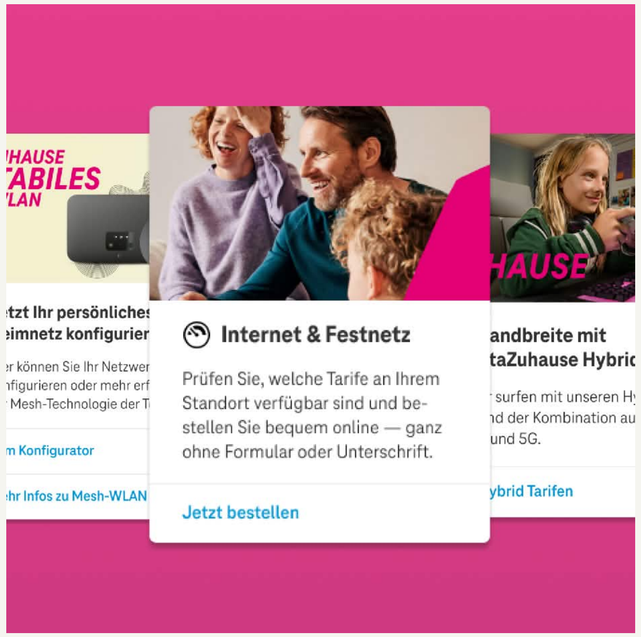
In this project, the existing Frag Magenta solution was extended with a conversational, fully automated sales channel.



Scalable sales innovation







Business value:
New revenue potential with a 4% conversion rate in conversational sales channels for fixed-line and TV products.

Higher sales productivity:
Less workload for customer service agents through automated sales processes.

Interactive customer experience:
A better customer experience through seamless, interactive chats.

From user insights to agile delivery – with a strategic focus

Conversational Sales Experience

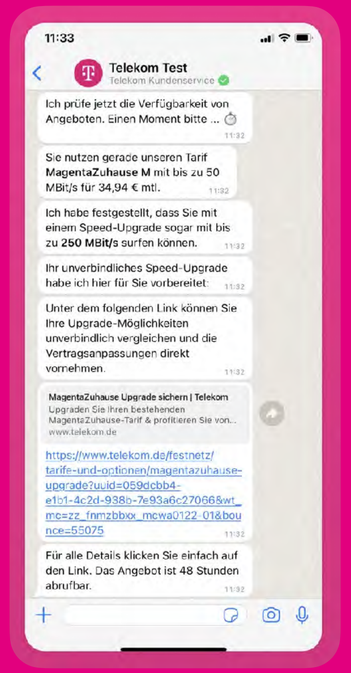
Conversational Sales Experience – Conversation flows and automation along the customer journey, based on user insights

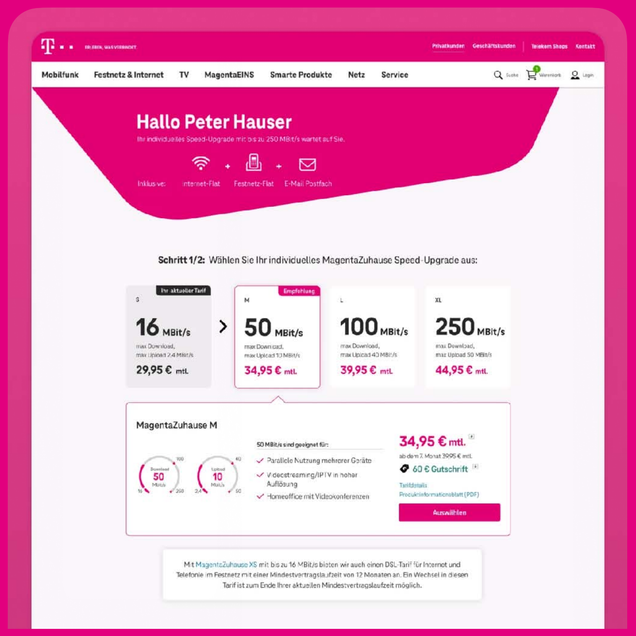
End-to-End Innovation Support

From use case to business case – including KPI validation, prototyping and decision papers for the internal stage-gate process

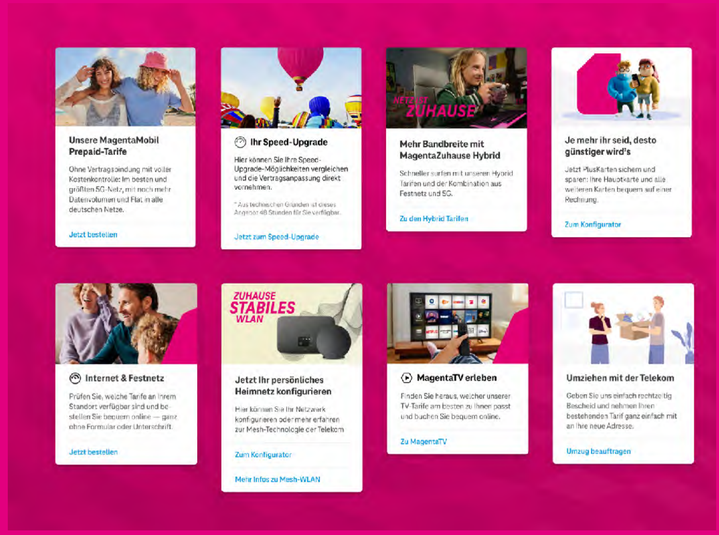
Agile Coaching & Management Alignment

Enabling cross-functional teams and developing strategic presentations for stakeholders and executive boards











- Research-led definition of an underserved target group: people who could invest, but never start
- Development of a gamified product concept for long-term retirement provision
- From discovery to MVP definition, brand and delivery plan

Goal

Define a new investment brand and its digital offering for the European market

Roles

Research lead, product concept

Methods

User and market research, interest-based customer profiles, fit-gap analysis, product concept, prototyping

Impact

A competitive brand and product focused on educational investing and peace of mind

First Arrow – Nimuna

Opening up investing for people who keep putting it off

First Arrow is an independent venture of a leading wealth-management software provider that also owns several digital banks.

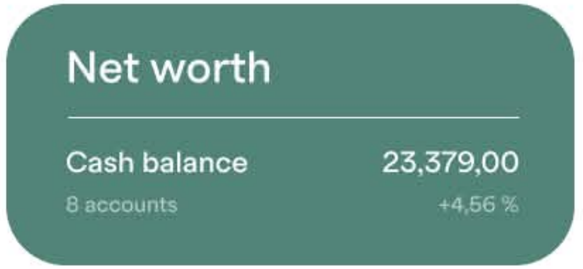
The goal: an investment brand that stands apart from banks and neobrokers, built on the client's existing platform.

Market research and user interviews led to one core profile: the Affluent Procrastinator. This person has the means and the intention to invest, but finds the topic dry and keeps putting it off.

Key findings driving product and strategy:
The barrier is emotional, not financial. Uncertainty and low trust stop people, not a lack of money.

The first step is too big. Too many options lead to paralysis before any decision is made.









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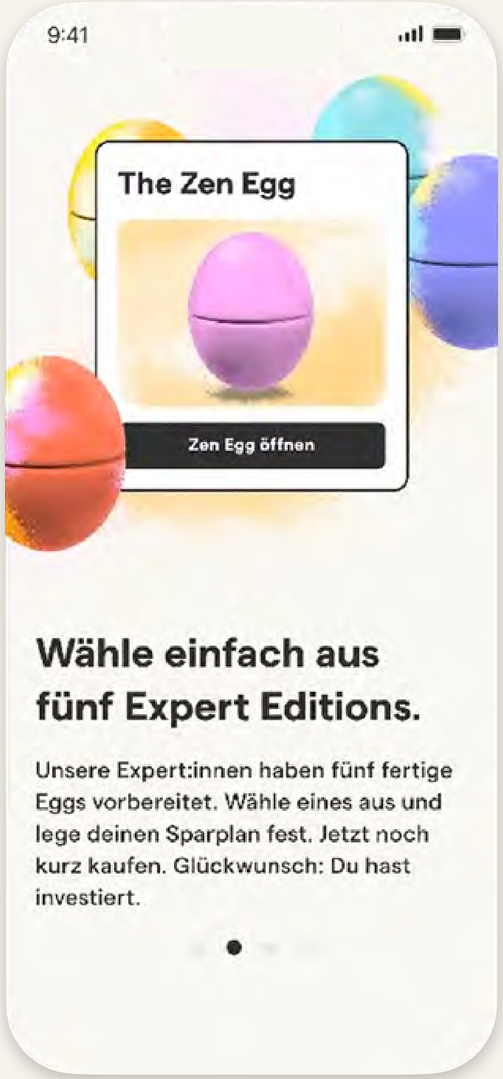
The Egg: a container that makes investing tangible

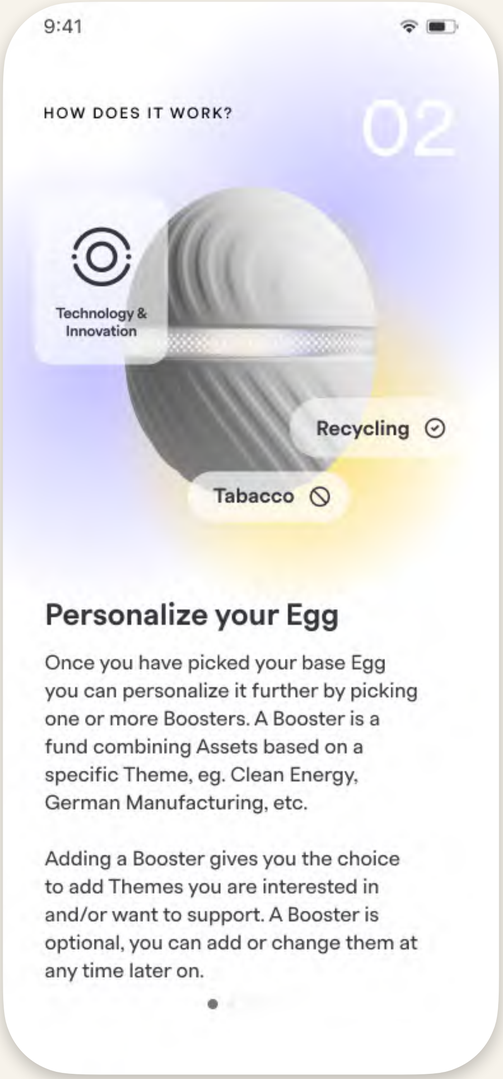
At the heart of Nimuna is the Egg, a digital piggy bank that grows in value. Each Egg holds a mix of funds, ETFs and shares that fits the user's life.

Start with one decision:
Five ready-made Eggs, curated by experts, range from conservative to dynamic. Choose one, set a savings plan, and the user has invested.

Make it personal:
Boosters add selected investments on themes such as renewable energy. Users can see what's inside their Egg by country, sector or company, and exclude what doesn't fit their values. They can also share an Egg with a partner or family.

Guided by AI:
Onboarding via chat, proactive suggestions along the investing journey and personalised content help users build confidence over time.



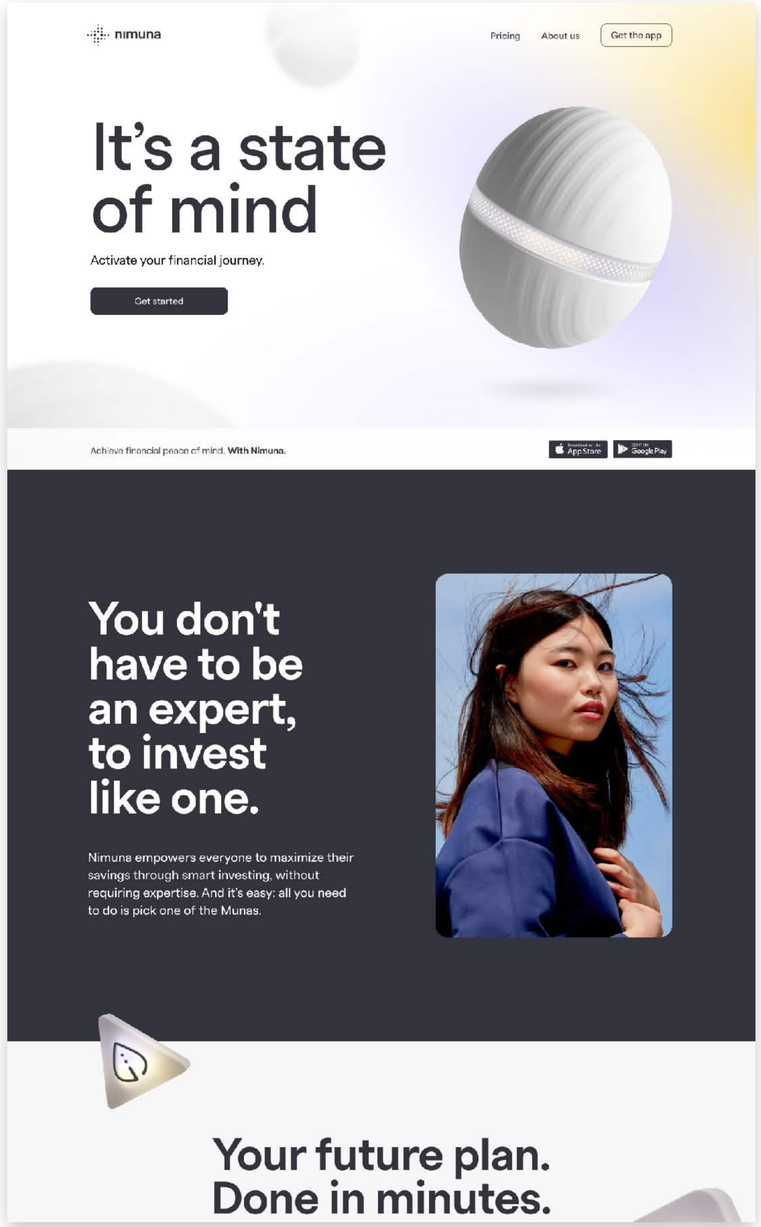


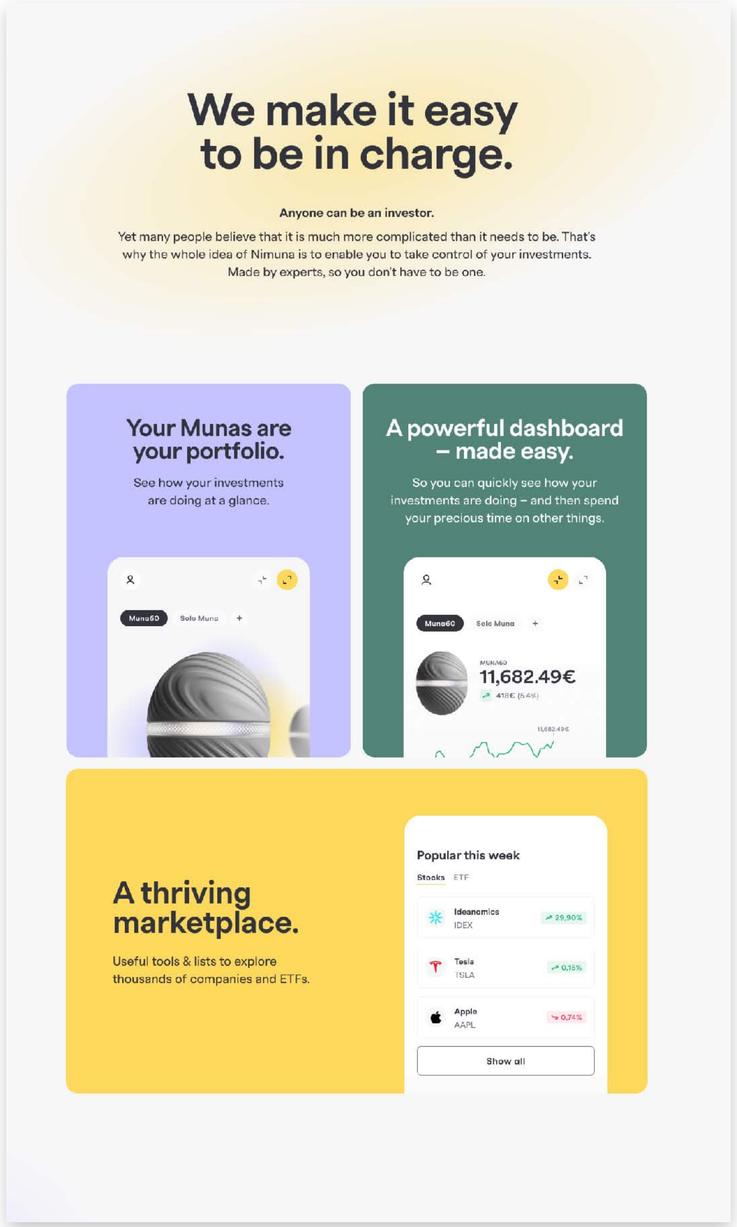
A brand that feels like peace of mind, built on proven infrastructure

Nimuna sells a feeling rather than a financial product: calm and confidence about one's money. Brand, tone of voice and campaign speak plainly and directly, without the usual financial jargon.

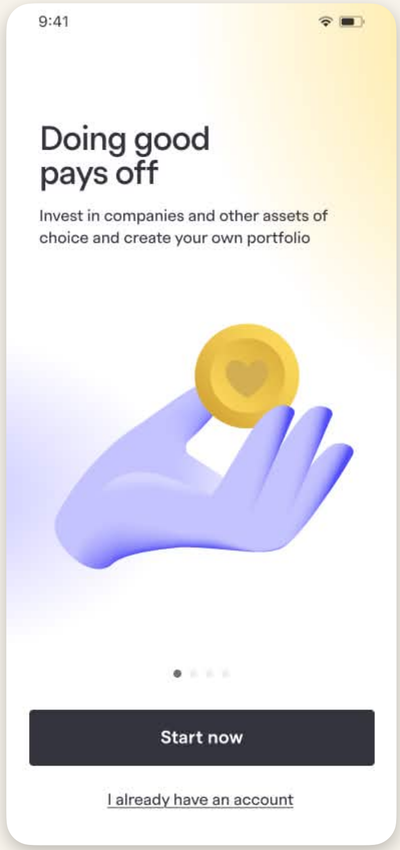
To get to market quickly, the product reuses the client's existing platform for trading, custody and reporting and integrates key services from its ecosystem.

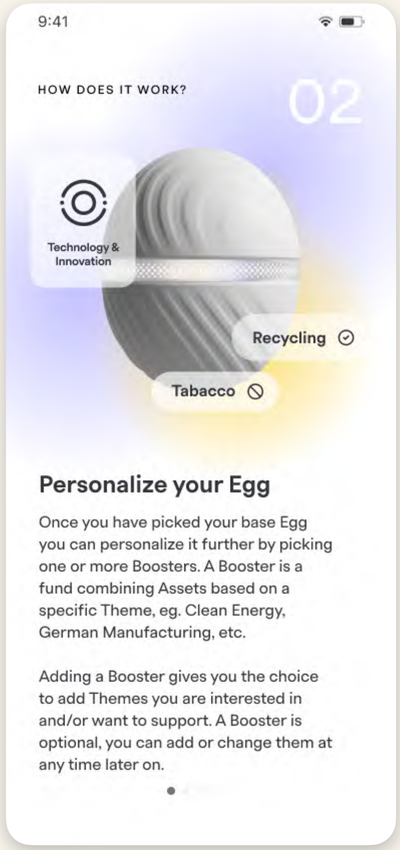
The delivery plan defined a staged roadmap: an MVP with a first investment marketplace, then multi-market rollout and continuous feature releases.

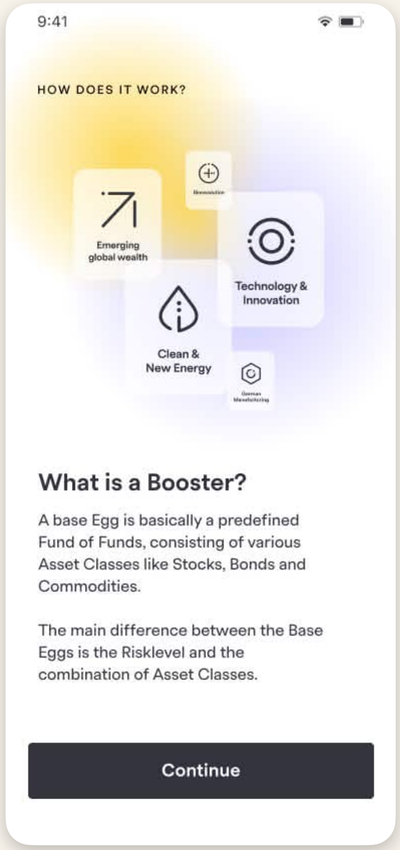


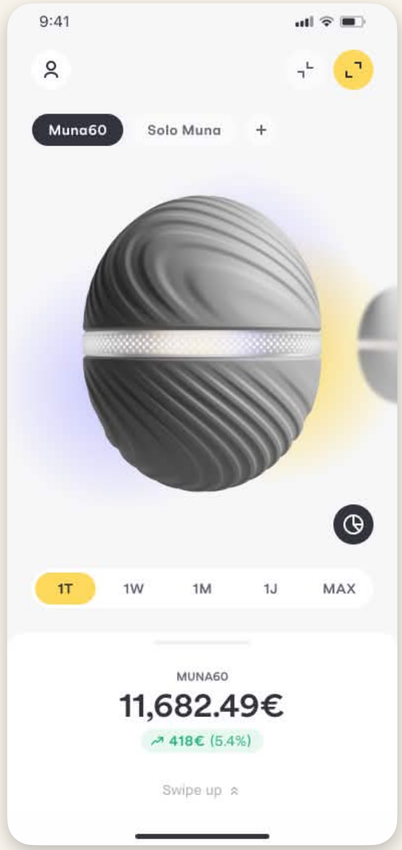


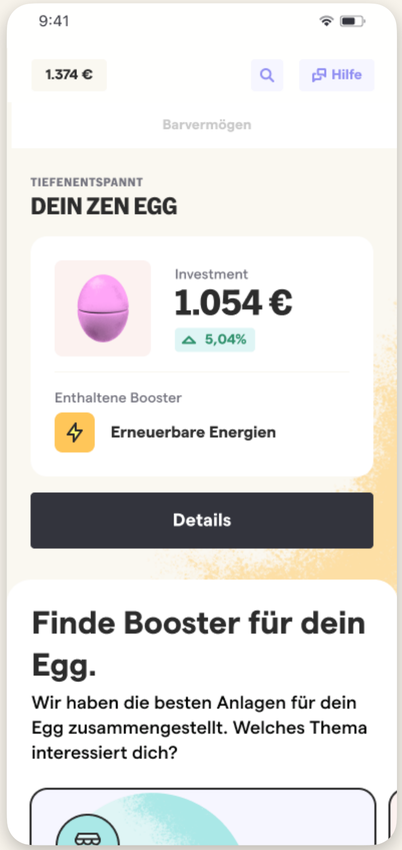
From first Egg to personal portfolio













- Transformed an extensive rider handbook into a situational tool for use during a multi-day bikepacking event
- Created a fully offline product with privacy built in by default
- Conceived, built and launched it end-to-end on my own, AI-first with Claude Code

Goal

Create an offline-first onboard guide that supports riders throughout the event

Roles

Product owner and developer

Methods

Prototyping, user testing, AI-assisted development, administration and deployment

Impact

Shaped the online and offline event experience; a reliable guide for 120+ riders before and during the event

An offline app turns documentation into action

SNEAK PEAKS is a series of bikepacking events in the Dolomites. Riders travel self-supported, without a support vehicle and without continuous network coverage.
An extensive rider handbook in PDF format documents the entire organisation and all safety-relevant information: complete and carefully made, but with two structural limitations.

1. The medium does not fit the situation.
The information is needed while riding – under strain, in poor visibility, without a connection. A text-based PDF is structured for completeness, not for the moment of use.

2. Access is not reliable.
Anyone looking for something on the road must have worked through the document beforehand. That cannot be guaranteed – and in an emergency it decides whether the right number, coordinate or exit option is found.



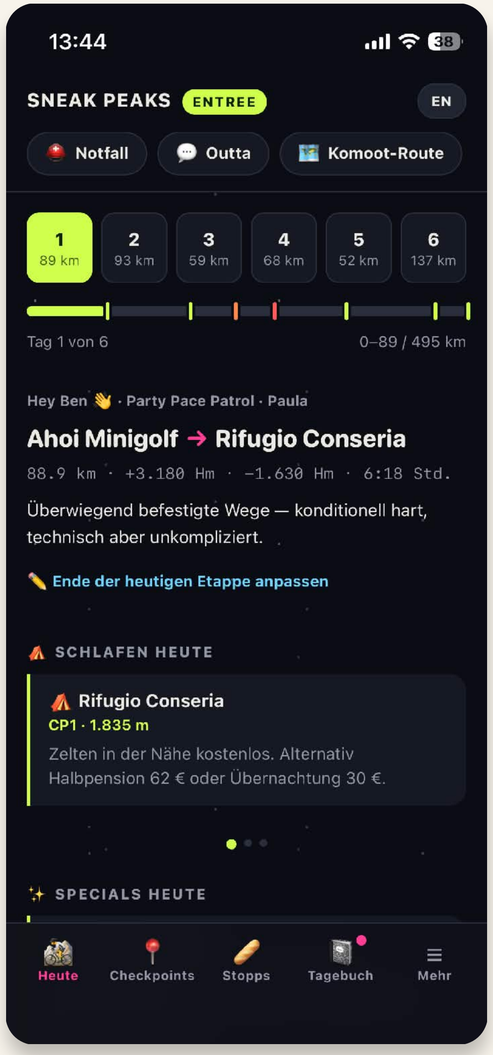
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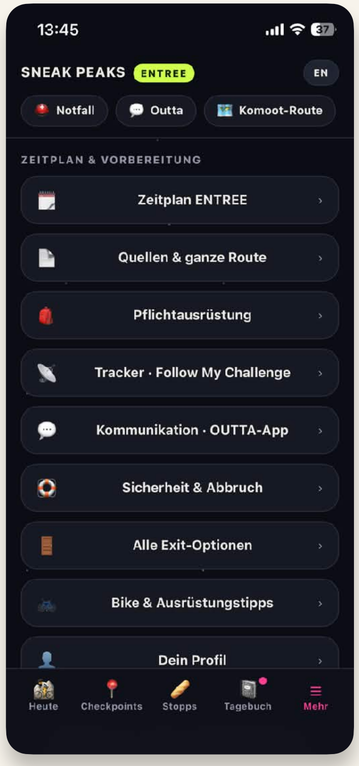
What matters now, not everything at once

A tool for the entire tour:
An offline-capable web app turns the rider handbook into usable views: stages with distance, elevation profile and weather, checkpoints and overnight stops with availability status, mandatory gear, exit options and emergency information.

Prioritised by situation:
Every area of the app shows what matters on the current stage. What is rarely needed stays out of the way. Information architecture and presentation follow the needs on the road, not the structure of the document.

Reliability as part of the experience:
Runs completely offline, without an account and without a server. The app works where network, time and concentration are missing.

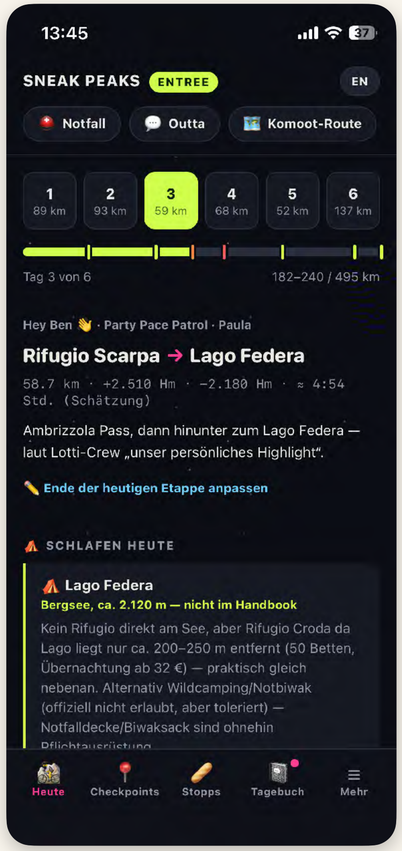




Structured by need, not by chapter

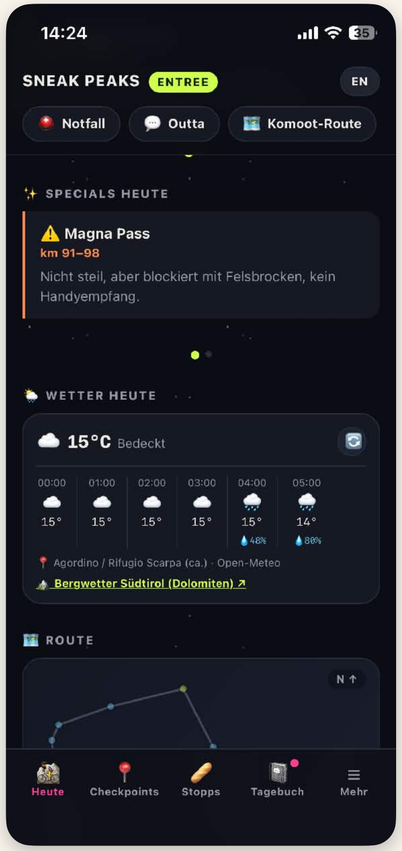
What lies ahead today?

Today's route at a glance



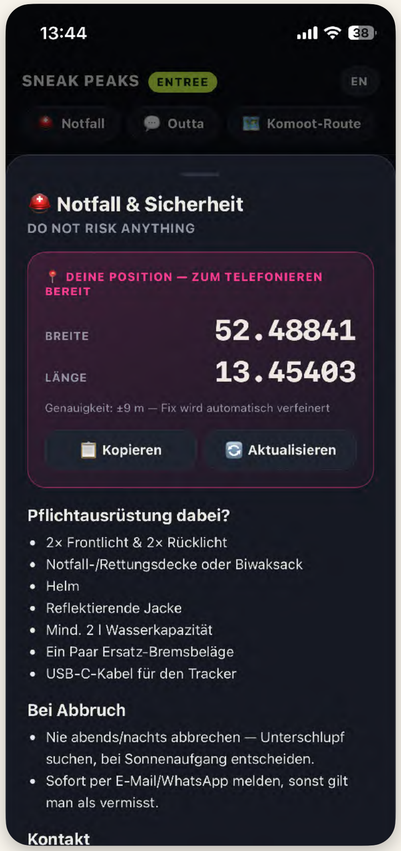
What awaits me on the way?

Conditions along the route



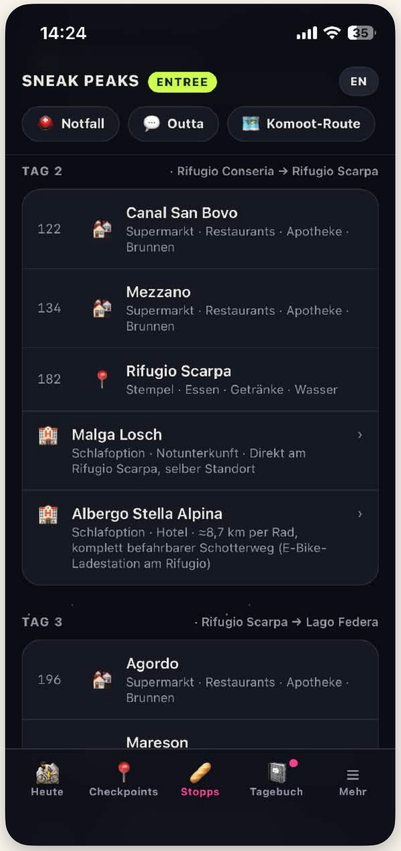
What if something happens?

Safety and emergencies



Where can I get what?

Resupply along the route



What have I experienced?

Journal with daily prompts



The field book in motion

The progressive web app is designed for moments when riders are tired or short on time, and when mobile signal is unreliable. Interactions stay simple and quick to use on the move.

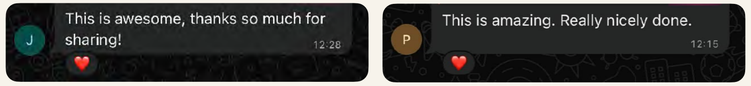
All content is available offline after the first visit, so the app works without a connection. I deployed it via GitHub Pages, which kept hosting simple and free of cost.

Try it live
Scan with your phone

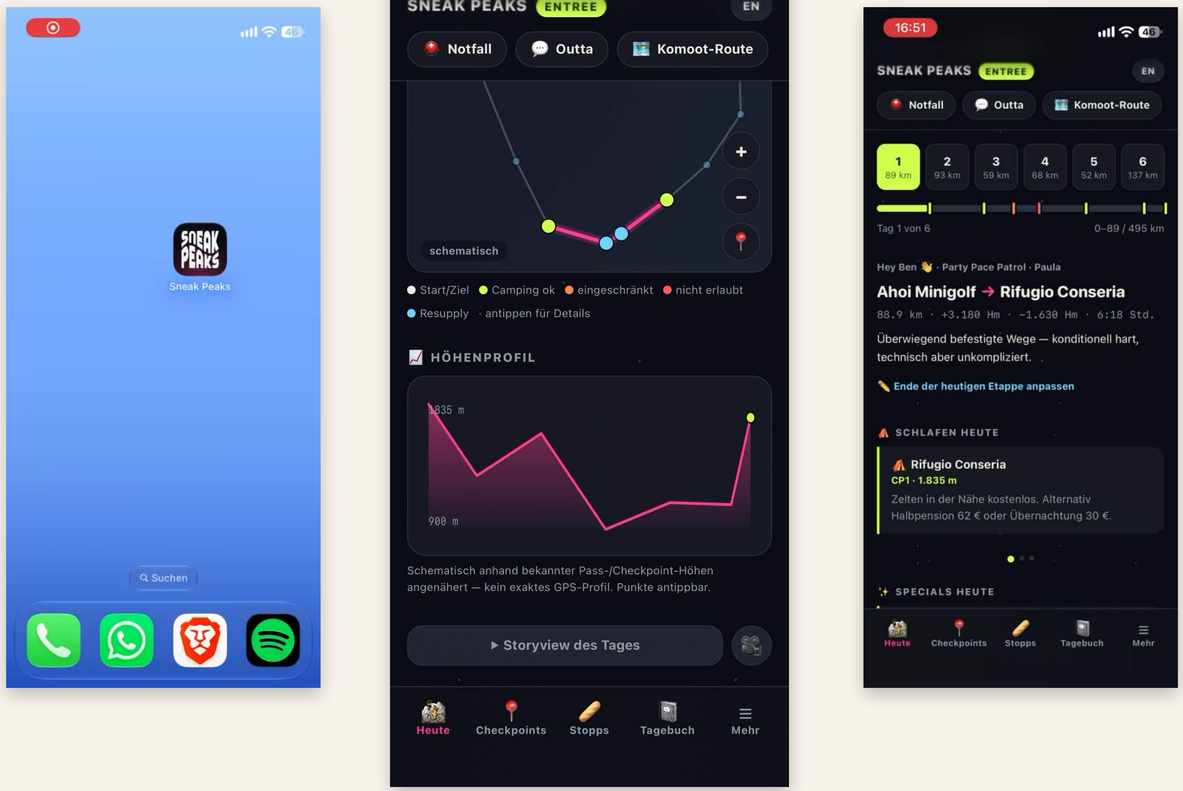
https://benedictgraf.github.io/entreeguide/

Click to play recording
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https://drive.google.com/file/d/1TNpHUe30GarDle9_rT3L_Tnx3QRjnVwi/view?usp=drive_link



Feedback from riders



Screen recordings from the live app

Kieback&Peter

brix2bytes

- Analysis of how buildings are currently managed with investors, facility managers and landlords
- Development of a SaaS platform with 8 interconnected tools for managing buildings sustainably
- Development of business models and partnerships

Goal

Create new business models and revenue streams by extending the company's hardware expertise into digital services.

Roles

Lead for service and product concept

Methods

Interviews with facility managers, hypothesis-driven validation (via expert reviews, landing pages, partner pitches), MVP prototype

Impact

From idea to validated MVP in one year, tested in real buildings with partners from healthcare and commercial real estate

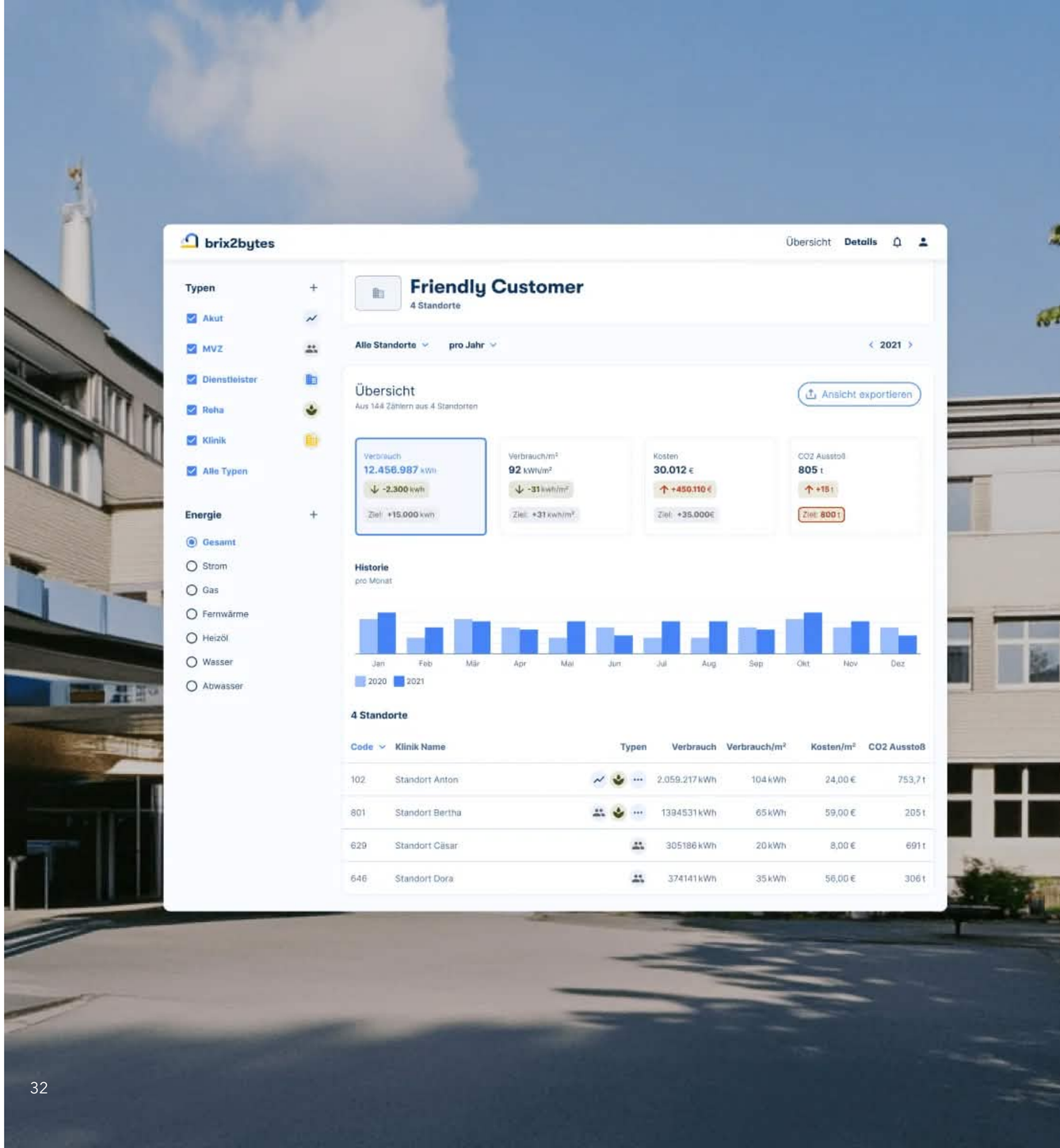
Making building energy data usable for the people who run buildings

Kieback & Peter has built hardware for building automation for decades.

The company wanted to expand its offering with digital services beyond its own devices to make property management more sustainable.

This resulted in an independent start-up offering a standalone platform that enables the sustainable management of buildings and portfolios for all target groups, opens up new business models and can operate independently of Kieback & Peter's core business.

Within one year, the idea became the IoT platform brix2bytes. The process was based on quantitative and qualitative research into users and markets. Project and decision structures were based on measurable hypotheses and continuous tracking. We validated the hypotheses with experts and through several evaluation methods, such as landing pages and pitches to potential partners like Bikini Berlin and Vamed hospitals.



Exploring how managing buildings works today and finding blank spots

We started with how building operators actually work. In qualitative interviews with facility managers and building owners, we followed their monitoring routines and where decisions about heating, ventilation and other systems get stuck.

Two findings shaped the product:

Little transparency on consumption: Operators could not easily see where energy went or how one building compared to another.

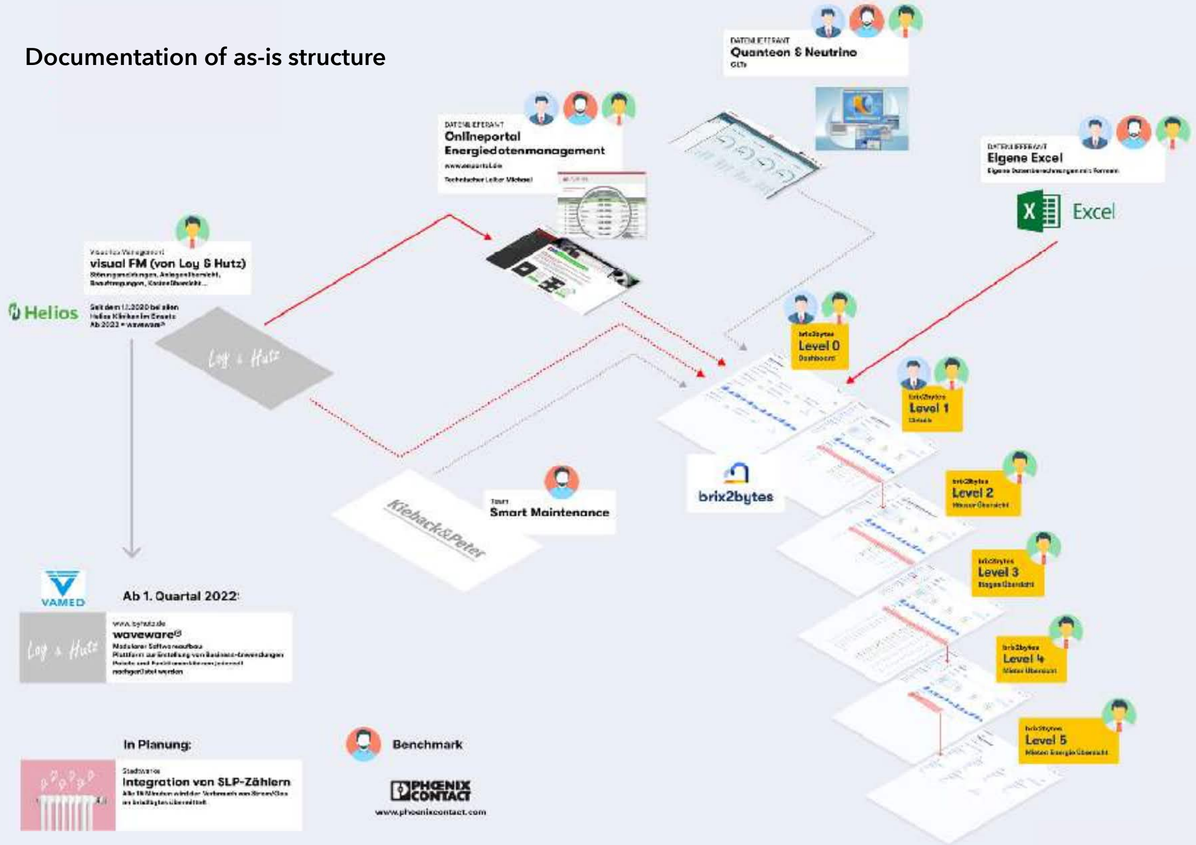
Monitoring took too much effort: Routines for checking and reporting data were slow and spread across tools.

In parallel, we analysed existing market solutions to see where a new platform could differ, and reviewed the client's systems and data sources to understand what data was really available.

Documentation of customer needs as customer profile



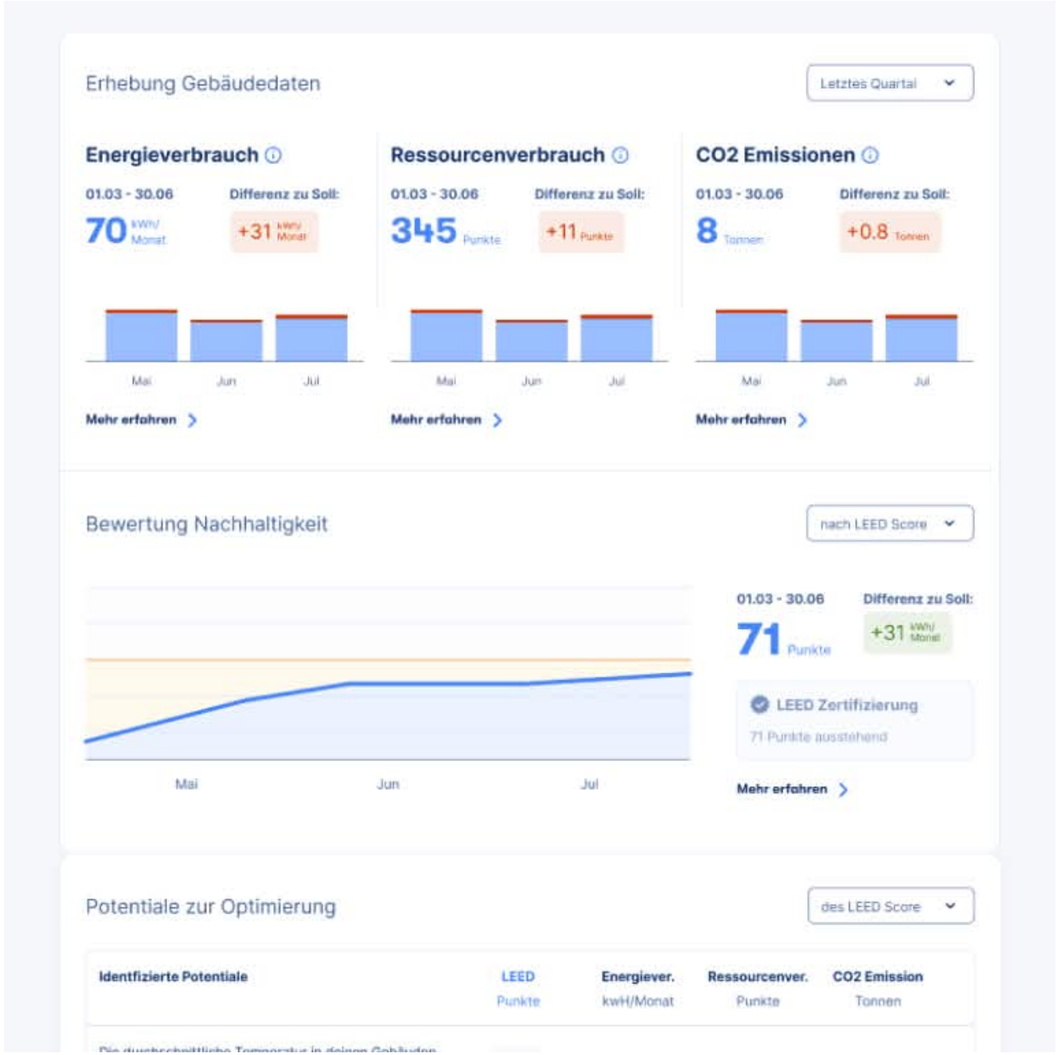
Documentation of as-is structure



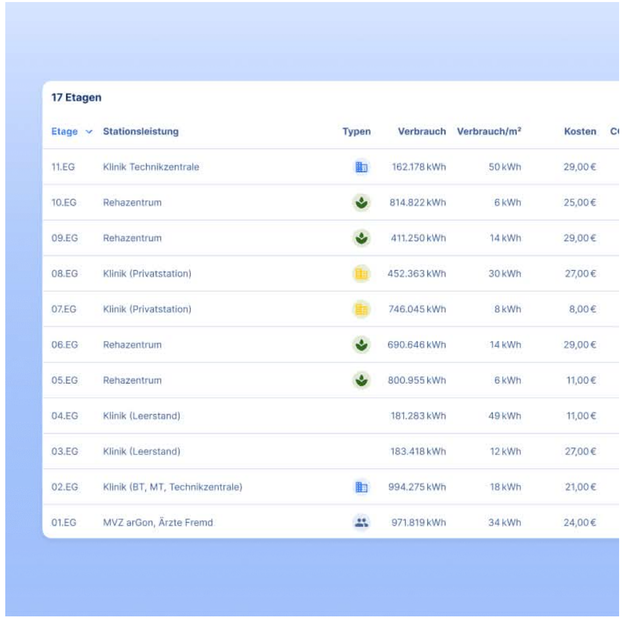
One platform that answers the operator’s questions

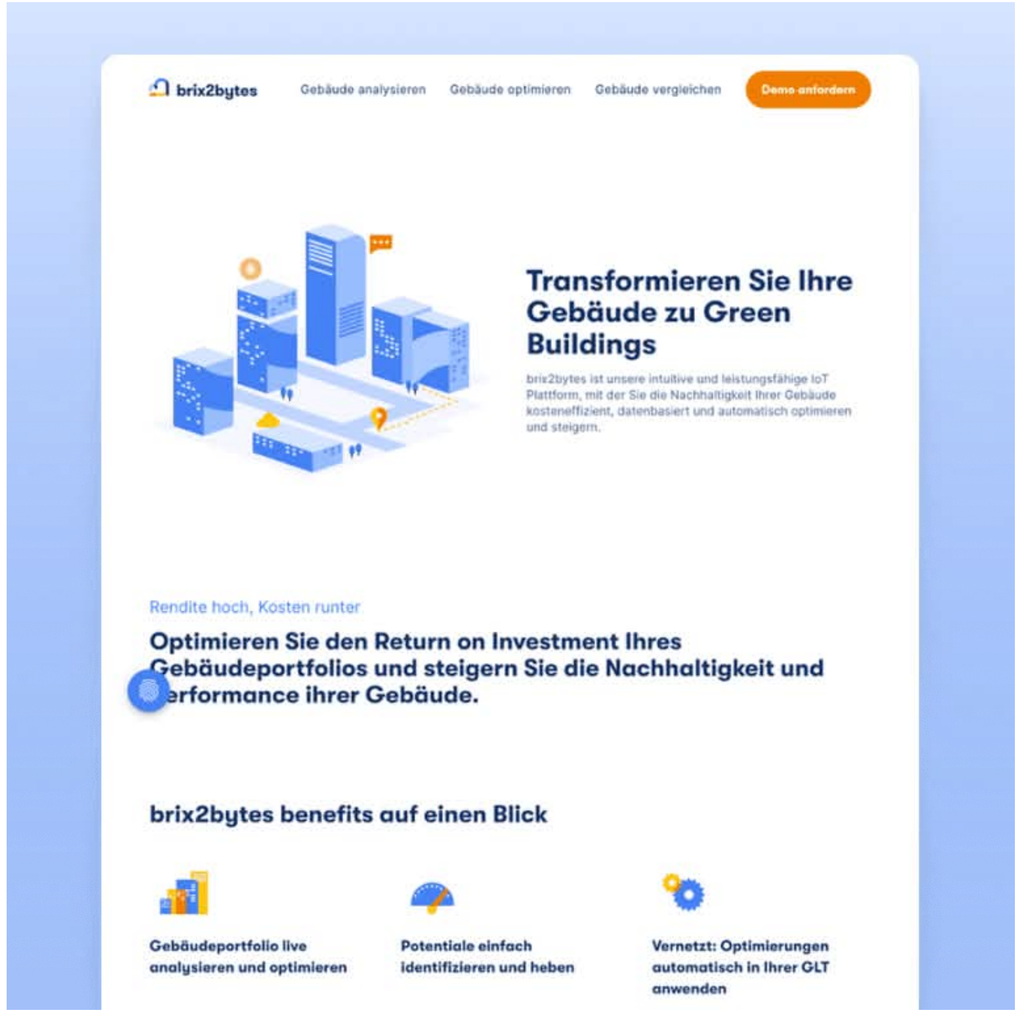
brix2bytes brings the energy data of every building into one place and makes it easy to read. Facility managers see their whole portfolio at a glance, spot the building that stands out and compare consumption across sites – the use case our research identified as the strongest lever for efficiency and cost control.

The MVP was tested in real buildings, where it helped operators save energy and make decisions about their systems based on data.



TO-BE: One platform to serve them all





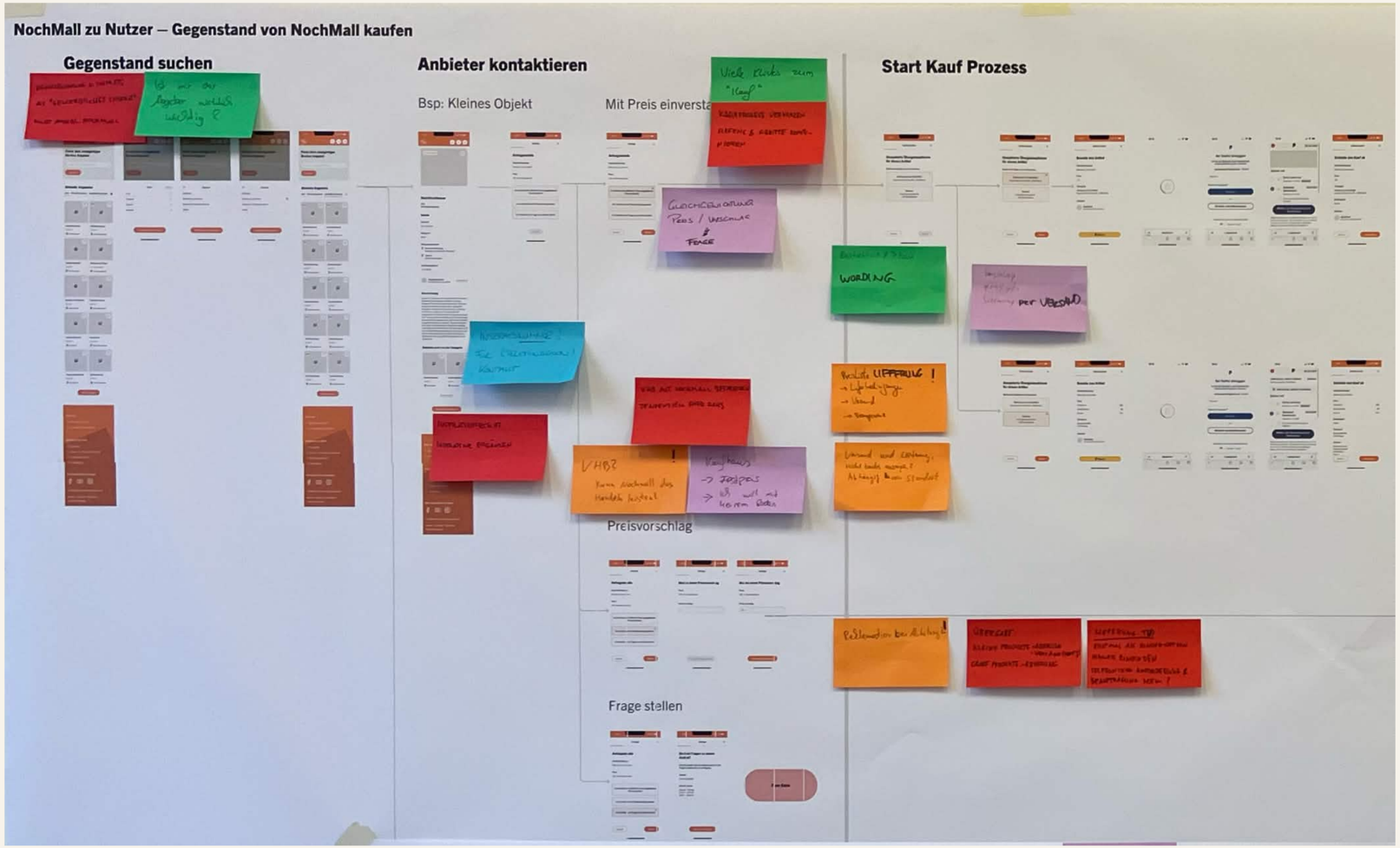


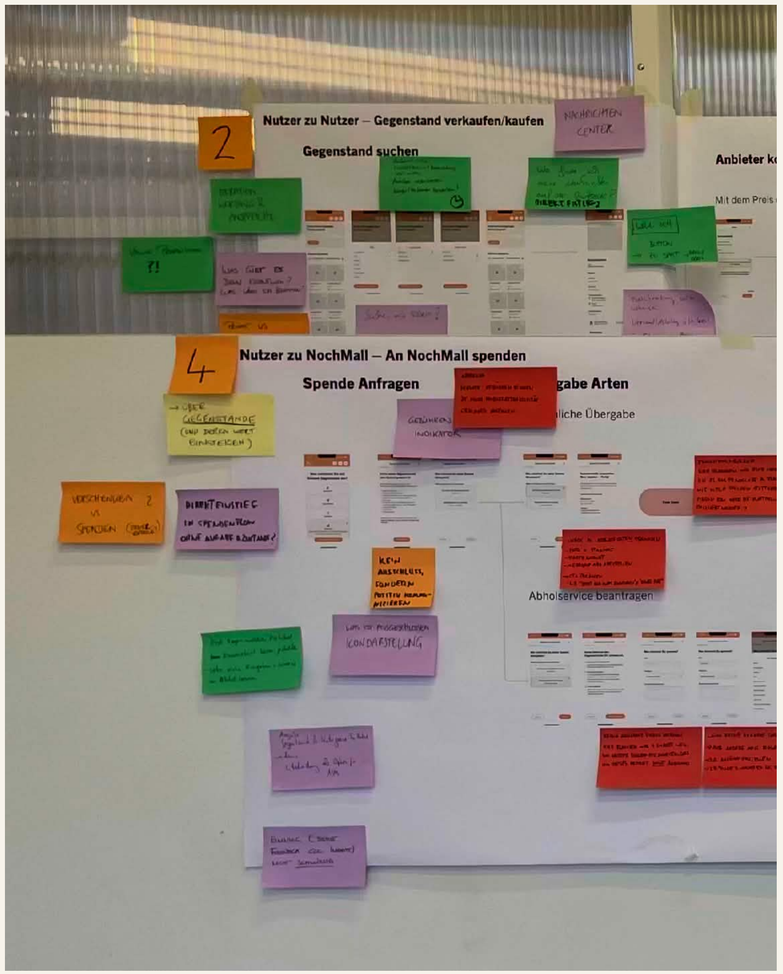
Methods and Tools

Across many roles, projects, industries and clients, I have built a continuously growing set of skills and tools that combines research, hands-on workshops and analytical documents – covering what it takes to build successful, user-centred solutions.

- KPI and tracking concepts, business cases, roadmaps and prioritisation
- User research, interviews, surveys, customer profiles
- Customer journey maps, experience maps, opportunity maps, value proposition mapping
- Service blueprinting, definition sprints, co-creation workshops
- AS-IS/TO-BE mapping, PESTEL analysis, inside-out/ outside-in analysis

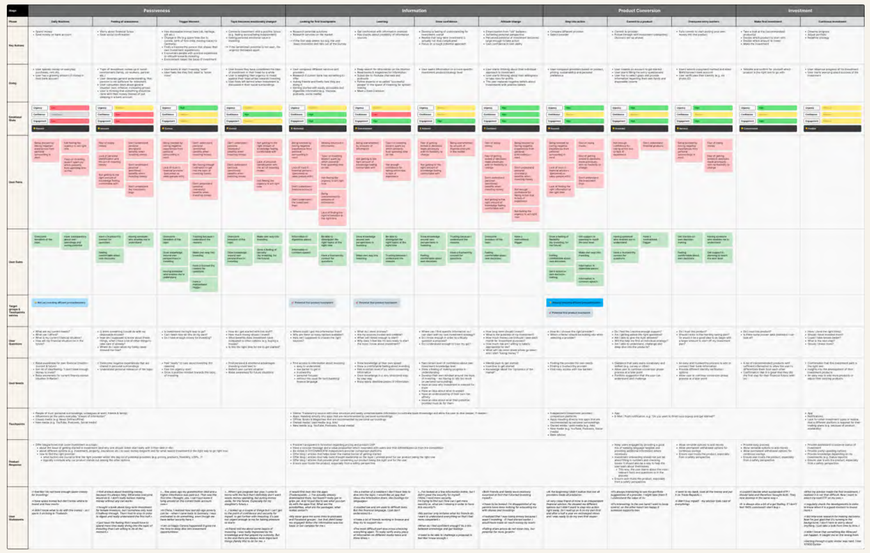
Making the back stage visible: how services actually get delivered

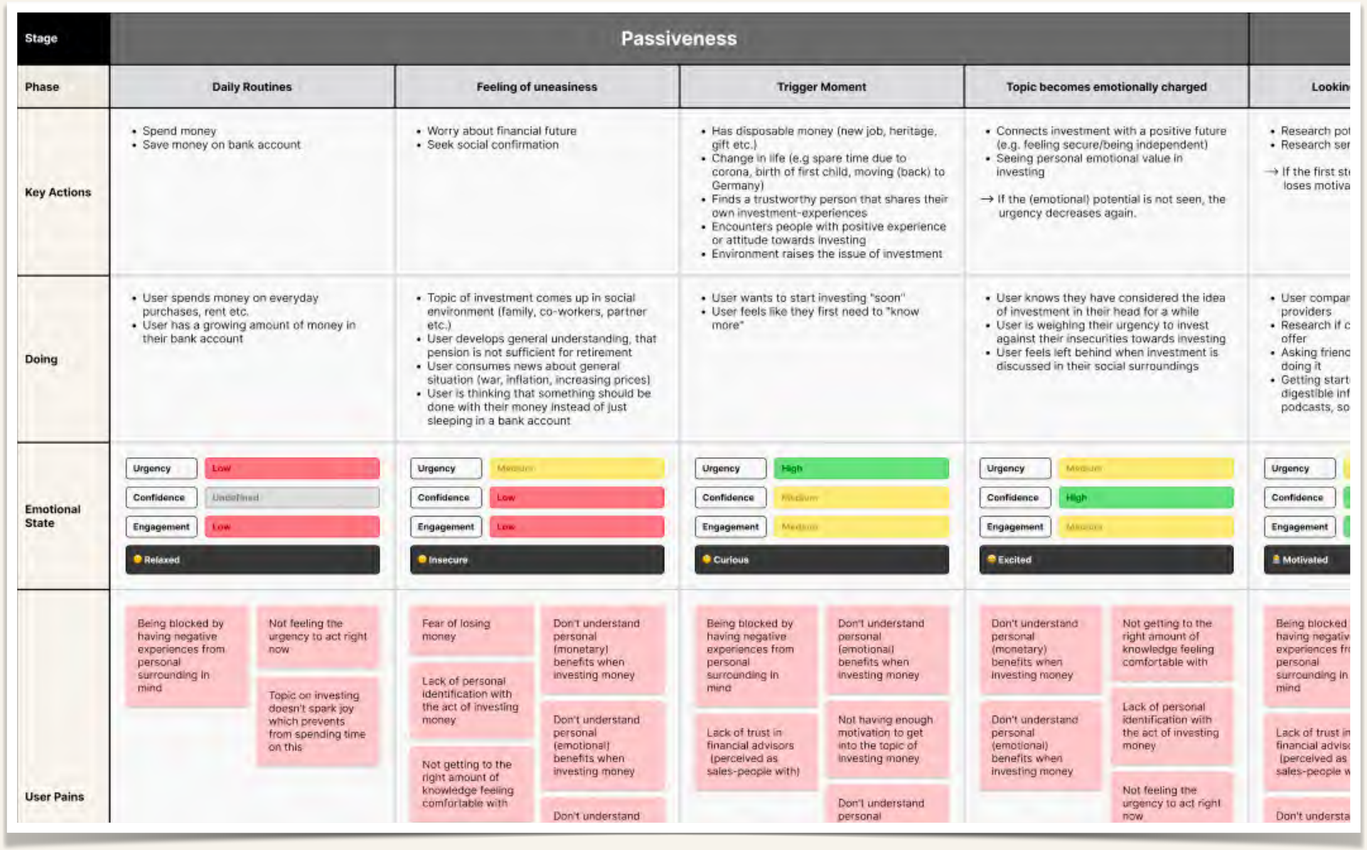




BSR – Service Blueprint (NochMall C2C marketplace)

Mapping out current states and pain points

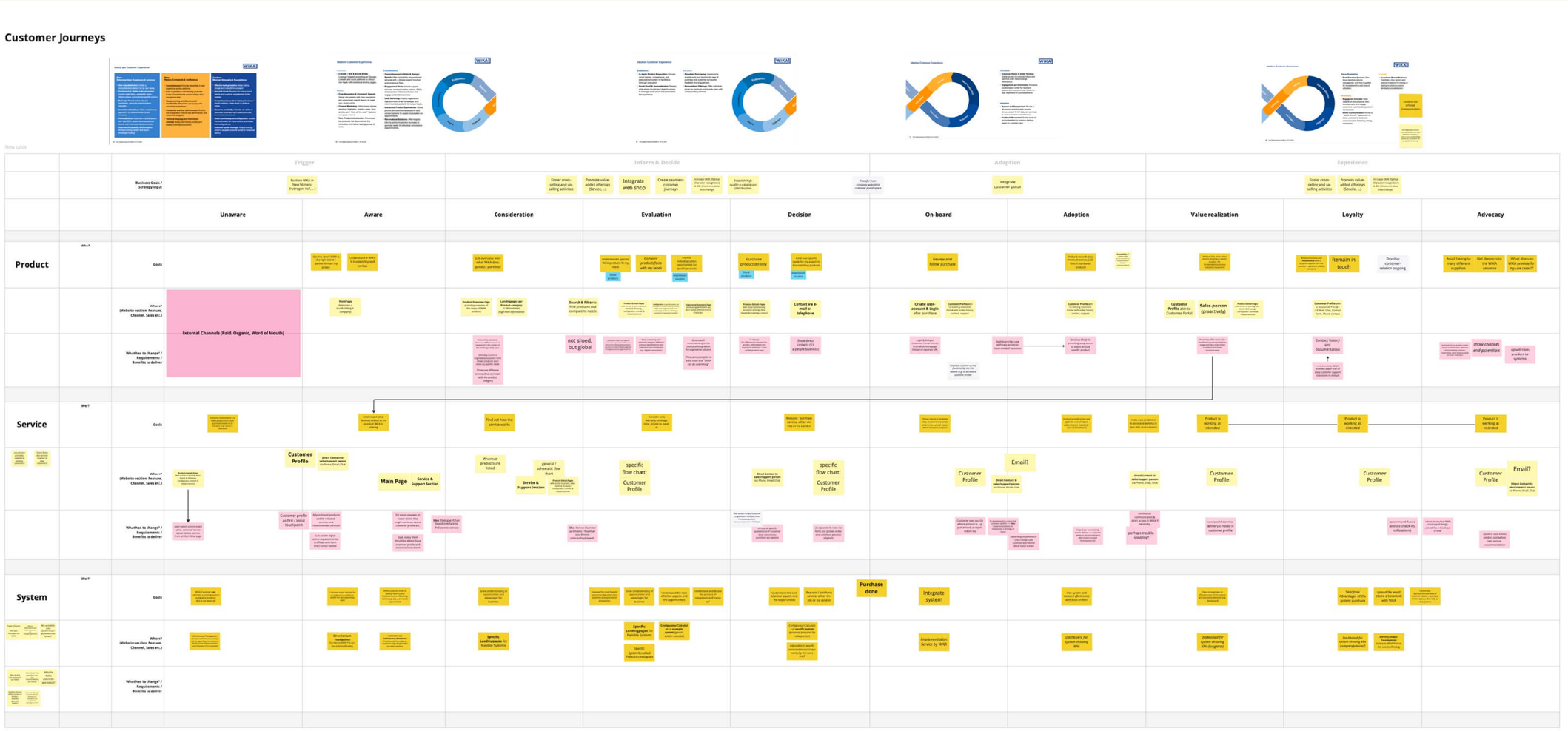




Stage	Passiveness				
Phase	Daily Routines	Feeling of uneasiness	Trigger Moment	Topic becomes emotionally charged	Lookin
Key Actions	• Spend money • Save money on bank account	• Worry about financial future • Seek social confirmation	• Has disposable money (new job, heritage, gift etc.) • Change in life (e.g spare time due to corona, birth of first child, moving (back) to Germany) • Finds a trustworthy person that shares their own investment-experiences • Encounters people with positive experience or attitude towards investing • Environment raises the issue of investment	• Connects investment with a positive future (e.g. feeling secure/being independent) • Seeing personal emotional value in investing → If the (emotional) potential is not seen, the urgency decreases again.	• Research pot • Research ser → If the first st loses motiva
Doing	• User spends money on everyday purchases, rent etc. • User has a growing amount of money in their bank account	• Topic of investment comes up in social environment (family, co-workers, partner etc.) • User develops general understanding, that pension is not sufficient for retirement • User consumes news about general situation (war, inflation, increasing prices) • User is thinking that something should be done with their money instead of just sleeping in a bank account	• User wants to start investing "soon" • User feels like they first need to "know more"	• User knows they have considered the idea of investment in their head for a while • User is weighing their urgency to invest against their insecurities towards investing • User feels left behind when investment is discussed in their social surroundings	• User compar providers • Research if c offer • Asking friend doing it • Getting start digestible inf podcasts, so
Emotional State	Urgency: Low Confidence: Undefined Engagement: Low Relaxed	Urgency: Medium Confidence: Low Engagement: Low Insecure	Urgency: High Confidence: Medium Engagement: Medium Curious	Urgency: Medium Confidence: High Engagement: Medium Excited	Urgency Confidence Engagement Motivated
User Pains	Being blocked by having negative experiences from personal surrounding in mind Not feeling the urgency to act right now Topic on investing doesn't spark joy which prevents from spending time on this	Fear of losing money Lack of personal identification with the act of investing money Not getting to the right amount of knowledge feeling comfortable with Don't understand personal (monetary) benefits when investing money Don't understand personal (emotional) benefits when investing money Don't understand	Being blocked by having negative experiences from personal surrounding in mind Lack of trust in financial advisors (perceived as sales-people with) Don't understand personal (emotional) benefits when investing money Not having enough motivation to get into the topic of investing money Don't understand personal	Don't understand personal (monetary) benefits when investing money Don't understand personal (emotional) benefits when investing money Not getting to the right amount of knowledge feeling comfortable with Lack of personal identification with the act of investing money Not feeling the urgency to act right now	Being blocked having negativ experiences fr personal surrounding in mind Lack of trust in financial advis (perceived as sales-people w Don't understa

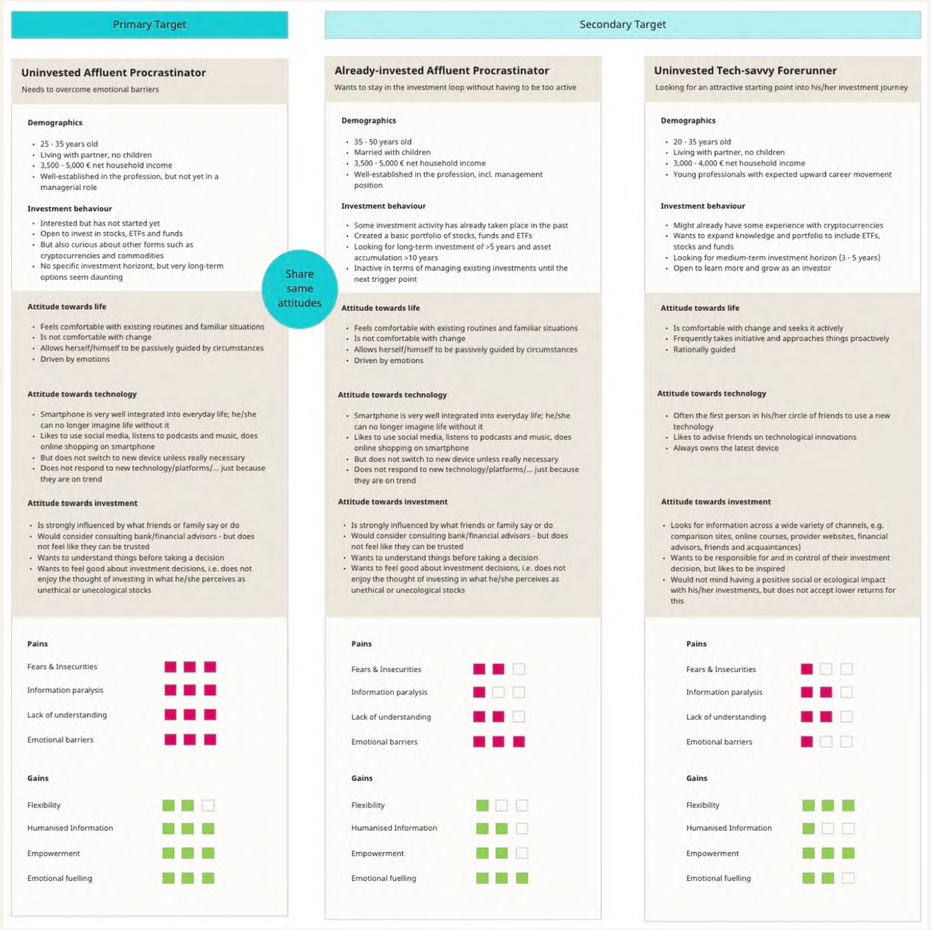
Experience Map for Nimuna

Visualising how users reach their goals along the CX loop



Customer Journey Map for an experience platform combining online shop, knowledge hub and company websites

Defining interest-based customers and their needs and goals

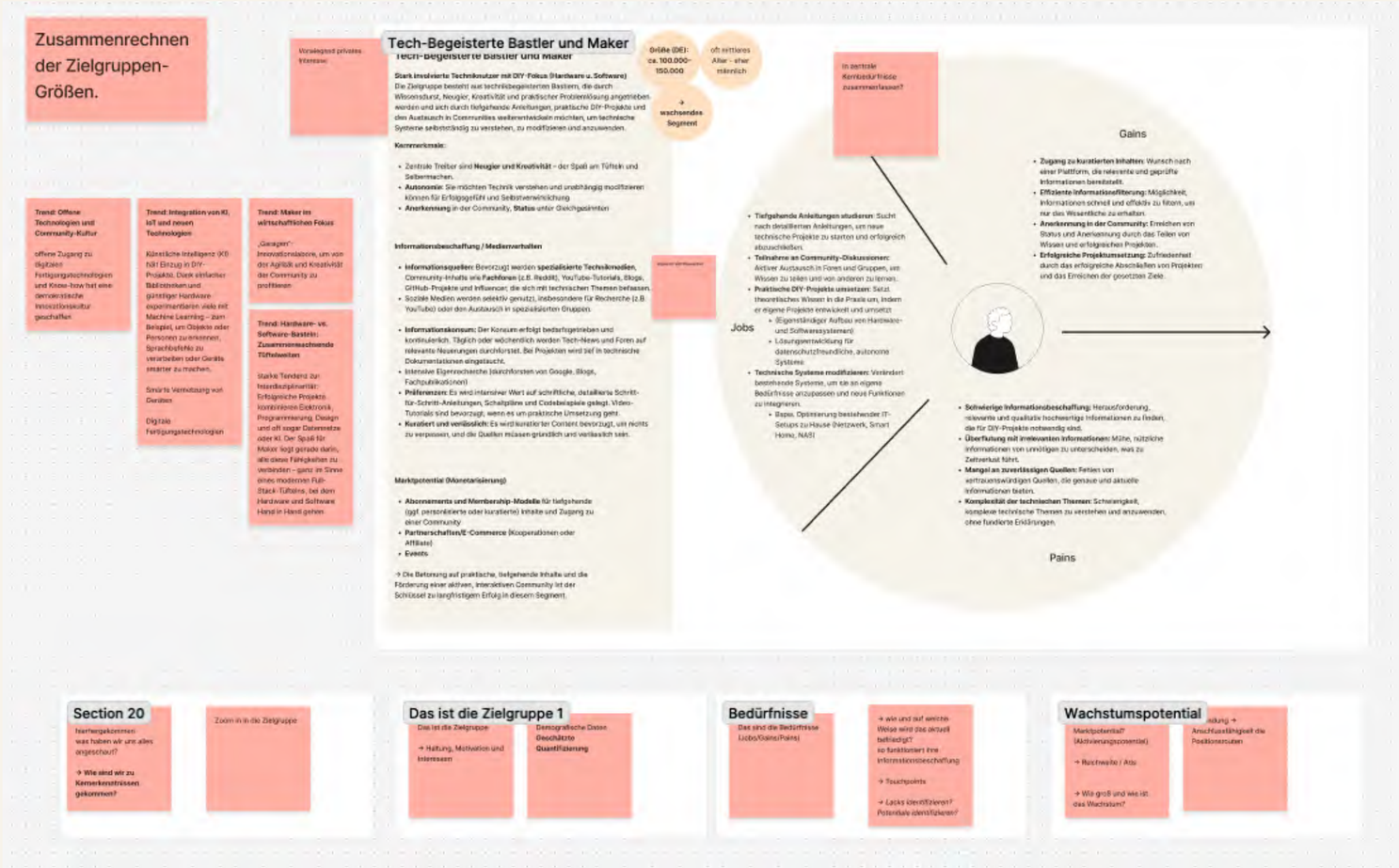


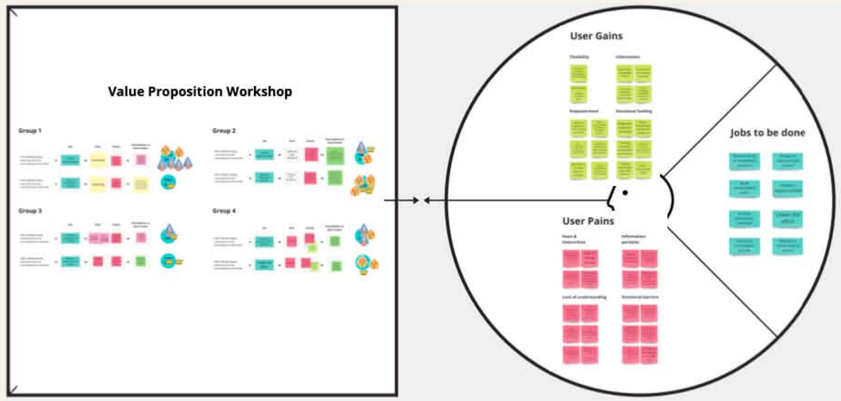
Interest-based Customer Profile for Nimuna



Interactive workshop to define customers and understand them in depth

From customer needs to value propositions





Interest-based Customer Profile and derived Value Proposition for a publisher's strategic positioning project

Thank you for your time.

I look forward to talking with you in person.

Benedict Graf

Product Experience & Digital Processes

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